

Word family: **shade / shades / shaded / shading / shady / sunshade / lampshade**

Base word: shade

Past tense: shaded

Past participle: shaded

Related forms: shading, shady

Useful family extensions: in the shade, throw/cast shade, shades of meaning, sunshade, lampshade

Part of speech: noun (名詞) / verb (動詞) / adjective-related family (相關形容詞)

Your sentence:

> “She does not move much, but she gives other people **shade**, stability, and comfort.”

Meaning in this passage

Here, **shade** comes from the literal idea of **protection from strong sunlight**, but the sentence uses it metaphorically.

An old tree gives people physical shade. Your grandmother similarly gives people:

* protection

* relief

* calm

* emotional shelter

* a sense of safety

So **shade** itself retains the idea of **shelter from something harsh**, while the surrounding metaphor extends that idea emotionally.

繁體中文： **原指遮擋陽光後形成的陰涼處；在這裡比喻某人為別人提供庇護、安慰和喘息的空間**

中文翻譯：

> “She does not move much, but she gives other people shade, stability, and comfort.”

「她也許不會有很大的動作，卻能為別人帶來**遮蔭般的庇護**、穩定和安慰。」

Here:

give someone shade = 像樹木遮擋烈日一樣，比喻為別人提供庇護、安慰和安全感

1. **shade = area protected from direct sunlight (陰涼處) — 樹蔭；陰影處；陰涼地方**

This is the literal sense underlying your passage.

Practice 1 — Literal basis of the metaphor

> “We sat in the ****shade**** of an old tree.”

「我們坐在老樹的****樹蔭下****。」

Practice 2

> “Let’s move into the ****shade****.”

「我們到****陰涼處****去吧。」

Practice 3

> “The trees provide welcome ****shade**** in summer.”

「這些樹在夏天提供令人舒服的****遮蔭****。」

****shade = 因物件阻擋陽光而形成、不受陽光直接照射的較陰涼區域****

2. ****give/provide shade (提供遮蔭) — 遮蔭；提供陰涼處****

This is especially important for your tree metaphor.

Practice 4

> “The large tree ****provides shade**** for people sitting below.”

「大樹為坐在下面的人****提供遮蔭****。」

Practice 5

> “We planted trees to ****give shade**** to the garden.”

「我們種樹，讓花園有****遮蔭的地方****。」

****provide/give shade = 阻擋直接陽光，形成可供人或物避開強烈日照的區域****

3. ****shade = shadow / darkness caused by blocked light (陰影) — 陰影；暗處****

A closely related physical meaning.

Practice 6

> “Part of the room was in **shade**.”

「房間有一部分處於**陰影中**。」

Practice 7

> “His face disappeared into the **shade**.”

「他的臉隱沒在**暗影中**。」

shade = 因光線被遮擋而形成的較暗區域

This overlaps with **shadow**, but the emphasis is often on the **area of reduced light**, not the exact silhouette.

4. **shade** = degree/variation of a colour (色調) — 色度；色調；顏色深淺

A major separate meaning.

Practice 8

> “I prefer a darker **shade** of blue.”

「我比較喜歡深一點的藍色**色調**。」

Practice 9

> “The walls are painted in a pale **shade** of green.”

「牆壁漆成淡綠色的**色調**。」

shade = 同一種顏色中的某個深淺、明暗或細微變化

Common:

- * a shade of blue
- * a darker shade
- * a lighter shade
- * different shades of red

5. **shade = slight difference / nuance (細微差別) — 細微差異 ; 意味**

This figuratively develops from colour shades.

Practice 10

> “The two words have slightly different **shades of meaning**.”

「這兩個詞有一些不同的**細微語義差別**。」

Practice 11

> “Her voice carried several **shades** of emotion.”

「她的聲音帶有多種**細微的情緒層次**。」

shade = 某種意思、感情或特質中的細微變化 / 差異

This is an especially useful language-learning sense.

6. **shades of meaning (語義細微差別) — 語義層次 ; 細微意思差別**

Practice 12

> “Good learners notice different **shades of meaning**.”

「優秀的學習者會留意不同的**語義細微差別**。」

Practice 13

> “These adjectives express different **shades of meaning**.”

「這些形容詞表達不同的**意思層次**。」

shades of meaning = 兩個或以上相近詞語之間不容易一眼看出的細微語義差別

This is very relevant to the polysemy work you are doing.

7. **shade = slight degree/amount (少許程度) — 一點 ; 一絲**

A more formal/literary figurative sense.

Practice 14

> “There was a **shade** of disappointment in her voice.”

「她的語氣中帶有**一絲失望**。」

Practice 15

> “His expression showed a **shade** of concern.”

「他的表情流露出**一點擔憂**。」

a shade of + feeling/quality = 某種情緒或特質只出現少量 / 輕微程度

8. **a shade + comparative (稍微.....一點) — 稍微 ; 略微**

A less common but useful formal expression.

Practice 16

> “The second version is a **shade darker**.”

「第二個版本**稍微深色一點**。」

Practice 17

> “Her answer was a **shade more cautious**.”

「她的回答**稍微更謹慎一些**。」

a shade + comparative = 程度上只比另一個稍微多一點

Register:

> somewhat formal / literary

9. **shade = protection / shelter metaphorically (庇護) — 庇護 ; 保護**

This is the figurative idea most relevant to your sentence.

Practice 18

> “The old tree became a symbol of **shade** and protection.”

「那棵老樹成為**遮蔭和庇護**的象徵。」

Practice 19

> “Her presence offered emotional **shade** during difficult times.”

「在艱難時期，她的存在給人一種情感上的**庇護和喘息空間**。」

shade = 比喻令人暫時避開壓力、困難或外界強烈刺激的保護 / 安慰

This is more metaphorical and literary than the everyday literal noun.

10. **shade** — verb = protect from sunlight (遮蔭) — 遮擋陽光；為.....遮蔭

Now **shade** functions as a verb.

Practice 20

> “The trees **shade** the windows in the afternoon.”

「下午時，樹木會替窗戶**遮擋陽光**。」

Practice 21

> “A large umbrella **shaded** us from the sun.”

「一把大傘為我們**遮陽**。」

shade something/someone = 阻擋直接光線，使其處於較陰涼 / 較暗的位置

11. **shade your eyes/face** (遮擋光線) — 遮住；擋光

Practice 22

> “She **shaded her eyes** with her hand.”

「她用手**遮住眼睛擋光**。」

Practice 23

> “He wore a hat to **shade his face**.”

「他戴帽子來**遮住臉部避免陽光直射**。」

shade + body part = 用物件阻擋陽光或強光照射某個部位

12. **shade** = make darker with drawing/colour (上陰影) — 塗陰影；加深

A major art/design verb meaning.

Practice 24

> “She **shaded** the drawing with a pencil.”

「她用鉛筆為圖畫**加上陰影**。」

Practice 25

> “The artist **shaded** one side of the face.”

「藝術家把臉的一側**畫得較暗**。」

shade = 在圖畫或設計中加入較暗的色調，以表現形狀、深度或光影

13. **shading** = use of light/dark tones (明暗處理) — 陰影處理；明暗效果

Practice 26

> “The drawing uses realistic **shading**.”

「這幅畫使用了很真實的**明暗陰影處理**。」

Practice 27

> “Good **shading** gives the object depth.”

「好的**陰影處理**能令物件呈現立體感。」

shading = 在圖像中利用深淺色調表現光線、立體感和深度的技巧 / 效果

14. **shading** = gradual variation (漸變) — 漸變；細微變化

Practice 28

> “The design uses subtle colour **shading**.”

「這個設計用了細緻的顏色**漸變效果**。」

Practice 29

> “The map uses different **shadings** to show elevation.”

「地圖用不同的**明暗色階**表示海拔。」

shading = 顏色或明暗程度逐漸變化的效果

15. **shady** = protected from sunlight (有樹蔭的) — 陰涼的；有遮蔭的

The main literal adjective.

Practice 30

> “We found a **shady** place under the trees.”

「我們在樹下找到一個**陰涼的地方**。」

Practice 31

> “They sat in a **shady** corner of the garden.”

「他們坐在花園一個**有樹蔭的角落**。」

shady = 因陽光被樹木或其他物件遮擋而較陰涼的

16. **shady** = suspicious / dishonest (可疑 / 不正當) — 可疑的；不光彩的

A major figurative sense.

Practice 32

> “That business deal sounds **shady**.”

「那宗生意聽起來很**可疑** / 不太正當。」

Practice 33

> “He was involved in some **shady** activities.”

「他牽涉一些**可疑、不光彩的活動**。」

shady = 看起來不誠實、不合法、不可靠或刻意隱瞞真相的

This is very common informal English.

17. **shady person/character** (可疑人物) — 不可靠的人；可疑人物

Practice 34

> “He seems like a **shady character**.”

「他看起來像個**可疑人物**。」

Practice 35

> “Be careful dealing with **shady** sellers online.”

「跟網上的**可疑賣家**交易時要小心。」

shady person = 行為或背景令人懷疑其誠信、合法性或動機的人

18. **throw/cast shade** (非正式) — 暗諷；貶低；含蓄批評

A very common modern slang extension.

Practice 36

> “Was she **throwing shade** at him?”

「她剛才是在**暗諷** / 含蓄地批評他嗎？」

Practice 37

> “The comment seemed to **throw shade** at her colleague.”

「那句評論似乎是在**暗暗貶低**她的同事。」

throw/cast shade at someone = 以間接、含蓄、帶嘲諷的方式批評或貶低某人

Register:

> informal / slang

19. **no shade** (非正式) — 沒有惡意 / 不是在批評

Practice 38

> “No **shade**, but I preferred the first version.”

「**不是要批評你 / 沒有惡意**，但我比較喜歡第一個版本。」

Practice 39

> “No **shade** to the team—they did their best.”

「**不是要貶低那個團隊**，他們已經盡力了。」

no shade = 表示接下來或剛才的說法不是刻意暗諷 / 貶低對方

Informal internet/spoken usage.

20. **shade** = blind/screen covering a window (窗簾 / 遮光簾) — 窗簾；捲簾

Especially common in American English.

Practice 40

> “She pulled down the window **shade**.”

「她拉下了窗戶的**遮光簾 / 捲簾**。」

Practice 41

> “Open the **shade** and let some light in.”

「把**窗簾 / 捲簾**打開，讓光線進來。」

****shade = 用來遮擋窗戶光線的簾 / 遮光裝置****

Regional note:

* ****window shade**** especially American English

* ****blind**** is also common

21. ****lampshade = 燈罩****

A very common compound.

Practice 42

> “The lamp has a white ****lampshade****.”

「這盞燈有一個白色****燈罩****。」

Practice 43

> “The ****lampshade**** softens the light.”

「****燈罩****令光線變得較柔和。」

****lampshade = 裝在燈泡周圍，用來遮擋、引導或柔化光線的罩****

22. ****sunshade = 遮陽設備；遮陽傘****

Practice 44

> “They sat under a large ****sunshade****.”

「他們坐在大型****遮陽傘 / 遮陽篷****下面。」

Practice 45

> “The car has a rear-window ****sunshade****.”

「這輛車的後窗有****遮陽簾****。」

****sunshade = 用來阻擋陽光、提供遮蔭的裝置****

23. ****shades = sunglasses (非正式) — 太陽眼鏡****

A common informal plural meaning.

Practice 46

> “He was wearing dark ****shades****.”

「他戴著深色****太陽眼鏡****。」

Practice 47

> “Don’t forget your ****shades****.”

「別忘了帶你的****太陽眼鏡****。」

****shades = sunglasses ; 非正式用語****

This is lexicalized in the plural.

24. ****shades = ghosts/spirits (文學 / 古典) — 幽靈 ; 亡魂****

A literary meaning.

Practice 48

> “The poem speaks of the ****shades**** of the dead.”

「這首詩談到死者的****亡魂****。」

Practice 49

> “Ancient stories describe ****shades**** wandering in the underworld.”

「古代故事描述****亡魂****在冥界遊蕩。」

****shade = 文學或古典語境中的亡魂 / 幽靈****

This is established but not high-priority everyday vocabulary.

Important distinction: **shade vs shadow**

This is the most important physical contrast.

shade

= an area protected from direct light, often useful/comfortable.

> “We sat in the shade.”

「我們坐在陰涼處。」

shadow

= the dark shape produced when an object blocks light.

> “The tree cast a long shadow.”

「樹投下長長的影子。」

So:

shade = 陰涼 / 較暗的區域

shadow = 具體投射出的暗影形狀

Important distinction: **shade vs shelter**

shade

specifically originates from protection against light/sun.

shelter

is much broader:

> protection from weather, danger, or exposure.

In your metaphor, **shade** works almost like emotional shelter, but its literal source is sunlight.

Important distinction: **shade vs colour**

colour

= broad colour identity:

* blue

* red

* green

shade

= one particular variation of that colour.

For example:

> navy and sky blue

are different:

> **shades of blue**

Important distinction: **shade vs tone**

In colour/design:

shade

often means a particular lighter/darker variation of a colour.

tone

can refer more broadly to the overall character or mixture of a colour.

In ordinary learner English, they often overlap, but **shade** is particularly common when choosing between versions of the same colour.

Important distinction: **shade of meaning vs meaning**

meaning

= the general semantic content.

shade of meaning

= a fine nuance within or between meanings.

For example:

> **warm**, **friendly**, and **affectionate**

may overlap but have different:

> **shades of meaning**

This concept is especially relevant to polysemy curation.

Important distinction: **shady — literal vs figurative**

Literal:

> “a shady garden”

= 有樹蔭的花園

Figurative:

> “a shady business”

= 可疑 / 不正當的生意

Same adjective, completely different modern meanings.

Important distinction: **shady vs suspicious**

suspicious

can mean:

* causing suspicion

* personally feeling suspicion

shady

specifically suggests:

> probably dishonest, illegal, hidden, or untrustworthy.

It is more informal.

Important distinction: **shade vs throw shade**

shade

ordinary noun:

> protection from sunlight

throw shade

slang:

> indirectly insult or criticize someone

The slang meaning should be learned as a fixed expression rather than treated as an obvious literal extension.

Important distinction: **shade vs shading**

shade

can mean:

* an area of reduced light

* a colour variation

shading

usually means:

> the technique/effect of making some areas darker, especially in drawing or graphics.

> “The drawing has good shading.”

= 圖畫的明暗處理很好。

Important distinction: **shade vs shades**

Plural **shades** can mean several different things:

different shades

= different colour variations

shades

informally:

= sunglasses

shades of meaning

= subtle semantic variations

shades — literary

= ghosts

So the plural deserves special attention.

Important distinction: **give shade — literal vs metaphorical**

This is central to your sentence.

Literal:

> “The tree gives shade.”

= 樹提供遮蔭。

Your metaphor:

> “She gives other people shade.”

= 她像老樹一樣，給人庇護、安慰和喘息的空間。

The metaphorical interpretation comes from the whole tree comparison.

We should **not** create a normal dictionary entry saying:

> **shade** = emotional comfort universally.

It is a contextual metaphor built from the literal shelter idea.

Family-extension note

Following the reference curation style, these are especially useful members and constructions of the **shade** family:

- * **shade** — sunlight protection = 陰涼處 / 遮蔭
- * **give/provide shade** = 提供遮蔭
- * **shade** — reduced light = 陰影 / 暗處
- * **shade** — colour = 色調 / 顏色深淺
- * **shades of meaning** = 語義細微差別
- * **a shade of emotion** = 一絲 / 少許情緒
- * **a shade + comparative** = 稍微更.....
- * **shade** — metaphorical shelter = 比喻庇護 / 喘息空間
- * **shade** — verb = 遮擋光線 / 為.....遮蔭
- * **shade a drawing** = 為圖畫加陰影
- * **shading** = 明暗陰影處理 / 漸變
- * **shady** — literal = 陰涼、有樹蔭的
- * **shady** — dishonest = 可疑、不正當的
- * **throw/cast shade** = 暗諷 / 含蓄批評
- * **no shade** = 沒有惡意 / 不是要批評
- * **window shade** = 窗戶遮光簾
- * **lampshade** = 燈罩
- * **sunshade** = 遮陽設備
- * **shades** — sunglasses = 太陽眼鏡
- * **shade/shades** — literary ghost = 亡魂 / 幽靈

As in the reference methodology, the literal sunlight sense, colour sense, figurative nuances, compounds, and lexicalized slang should all be checked, while context-specific metaphor should not be mistaken for a permanent new dictionary sense.

Master comparison

Form / sense	MCQ-ready Traditional Chinese meaning
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shade — sunlight protection	因物件阻擋陽光而形成、不受直接日照的較陰涼區域
give/provide shade	阻擋直接陽光，為人 / 物形成陰涼區域

shade — reduced light	因光線被遮擋而形成的較暗區域	
shade — colour	同一顏色中的某個深淺、明暗或細微變化	
shades of meaning	相近詞語 / 意思之間細微而重要的語義差別	
a shade of feeling	某種情緒或特質只出現少量 / 輕微程度	
a shade + comparative	程度上只比另一個稍微多一點	
shade — contextual metaphor	從遮陽庇護延伸出的比喻性保護、安慰或喘息感	
shade — verb	阻擋直接光線，使某人 / 某物處於較陰涼或較暗位置	
shade — art	在圖畫 / 設計中加深部分色調以表現光影和立體感	
shading — art/design	利用明暗深淺表現光線、立體感或色彩漸變的技巧 / 效果	
shady — literal	因陽光被遮擋而較陰涼的	
shady — figurative	看起來不誠實、不合法、不可靠或刻意隱瞞的	
throw/cast shade	以間接、含蓄、帶嘲諷方式批評或貶低某人	
no shade	表示某句話並非刻意暗諷或貶低對方	
window shade	用來遮擋窗戶光線的簾 / 遮光裝置	
lampshade	裝在燈泡周圍、用來遮擋或柔化光線的罩	
sunshade	用來阻擋陽光、提供遮蔭的裝置	
shades — sunglasses	非正式用語；太陽眼鏡	
shade/shades — literary	文學 / 古典語境中的亡魂或幽靈	

For your original sentence

> “She does not move much, but she gives other people **shade**, stability, and comfort.”

The literal underlying meaning is:

****shade = 樹木遮擋陽光後為人提供的陰涼和庇護****

But within the old-tree metaphor, it means:

> ****give other people shade****

= ****「像一棵大樹替人遮蔭一樣，為別人提供庇護、安慰、安全感和喘息空間」****

The important curation point is that the passage is ****creating the emotional meaning metaphorically****.

We should therefore keep:

> ****shade = physical shelter from sunlight****

as the lexical anchor,

while explaining that the sentence figuratively maps:

> ****harsh sunlight → life's pressures/difficulties****

> ****tree shade → emotional shelter and comfort****

That preserves the distinction between genuine polysemy and a context-created metaphor, exactly in line with the SOP.